

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 15, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 40:1-16

1 In the twenty-fifth year of our captivity, at the beginning of the year, on the tenth day of the month, in the fourteenth year after the city was captured, on the very same day the hand of the LORD was upon me; and He took me there.

2 In the visions of God He took me into the land of Israel and set me on a very high mountain; on it toward the south was something like the structure of a city.

3 He took me there, and behold, there was a man whose appearance was like the appearance of bronze. He had a line of flax and a measuring rod in his hand, and he stood in the gateway.

4 And the man said to me, "Son of man, look with your eyes and hear with your ears, and fix your mind on everything I show you; for you were brought here so that I might show them to you. Declare to the house of Israel everything you see."

5 Now there was a wall all around the outside of the temple. In the man's hand was a measuring rod six cubits long, each being a cubit and a handbreadth; and he measured the width of the wall structure, one rod; and the height, one rod.

6 Then he went to the gateway which faced east; and he went up its stairs and measured the threshold of the gateway, which was one rod wide, and the other threshold was one rod wide.

7 Each gate chamber was one rod long and one rod wide; between the gate chambers was a space of five cubits; and the threshold of the gateway by the vestibule of the inside gate was one rod.

8 He also measured the vestibule of the inside gate, one rod.

9 Then he measured the vestibule of the gateway, eight cubits; and the gateposts, two cubits. The vestibule of the gate was on the inside.

10 In the eastern gateway were three gate chambers on one side and three on the other;

the three were all the same size; also the gateposts were of the same size on this side and that side.

11 He measured the width of the entrance to the gateway, ten cubits; and the length of the gate, thirteen cubits.

12 There was a space in front of the gate chambers, one cubit on this side and one cubit on that side; the gate chambers were six cubits on this side and six cubits on that side.

13 Then he measured the gateway from the roof of one gate chamber to the roof of the other; the width was twenty-five cubits, as door faces door.

14 He measured the gateposts, sixty cubits high, and the court all around the gateway extended to the gatepost.

15 From the front of the entrance gate to the front of the vestibule of the inner gate was fifty cubits.

16 There were beveled window frames in the gate chambers and in their intervening archways on the inside of the gateway all around, and likewise in the vestibules. There were windows all around on the inside. And on each gatepost were palm trees.

II. Key Summary

- The vision comes in the twenty-fifth year of the exile, on the tenth day of the first month, fourteen years after Jerusalem was captured; the hand of the LORD comes on Ezekiel and takes him to the land of Israel.
 - God sets Ezekiel on a very high mountain, where he sees something like the structure of a city to the south, and a man whose appearance is like bronze standing in the gateway with a line of flax and a measuring rod.
 - The man tells Ezekiel to look, listen, fix his mind on everything, and declare all of it to the house of Israel; then, starting at the east gate, he measures the wall, the thresholds, the gate chambers, the gateposts, and the vestibules one by one.
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III. Passage Analysis

The Ruins Are Still There, and the Vision Comes Anyway

"The hand of the Lord was upon me and brought me thither to Jerusalem, now that it was in ruins, desolate and deserted—a pitiable sight to the prophet." [1]

The city Ezekiel is taken to see is one he knows has been rubble for fourteen years. God does not wait for things to improve before speaking; He shows the rebuilt version right there at the worst site.

Measured That Carefully Because It's Real

"The measurements are: (1) exact, to show that the promise is certain; (2) equal, to denote harmony; (3) vast, to mark majesty and grandeur." [2]

One rod, six cubits, thirteen cubits—the whole chapter reads like a set of blueprints, and that is exactly the point: something you can measure is something you intend to build. The hope God gives here comes with specifications, not just comforting words.

IV. Reflection Question

When someone tells you "don't worry, it'll be fine," what actually goes through your head? Do you feel genuinely comforted, or does it sound like something people just say when they don't really know how things will turn out?

God did not simply tell Ezekiel it would be fine. He took him to see a temple and had it measured out for him rod by rod—how thick the wall was, how wide the gate, how tall the gateposts. Hope gets spelled out in that much detail when there is a real intention to build it.

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Complete Commentary (Ezekiel 40),
https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_040.cfm

[2] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Ezekiel 40:4),
<https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/40-4.htm>